

that a strong market uptrend tends to push price higher (that is, the average rise is higher in bull markets than bear markets). If you're starving for clichés, then I have two: A rising tide lifts all boats and trade with the (market) trend.

Days to ultimate high. High, tight flags are rockets, reaching the ultimate high in about a month to 6 weeks on average. The median is just 18 days. That's fast.

How many change trend? This is a measure of how many flags see price rise more than 20% after the breakout. I consider values more than 50% to be good, but 55% is the average for all bullish chart patterns. Bear markets fall short of the average made by all other chart pattern types (which see 46% rising more than 20%).

[Table 35.3](#) shows failure rates for high, tight flags. I found that 15% of the patterns will fail to see price rise more than 5% after a bull market breakout. Over a third (38%) will fail to see price rise more than 15%. This is the kill zone, a rise of 10% to 15% where I've noticed a lot of the patterns die.

[Table 35.4](#) shows breakout-related statistics for flags.

Breakout direction. By definition, the breakout is always upward. If price closes below the bottom of the flag, then that's a downward breakout. Ignore the pattern. It's a high, tight flag that's failed.